

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS----- X
ROQUE CONTRERAS,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff, Index No.:

-against-

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of IncidentTHE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER DANIEL
TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, NYPD SERGEANT
SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, and NYPD
OFFICERS JOHN AND JANE DOE NUMBERS 1-10,Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.Defendants.
----- X

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
July 7, 2021

Yours, etc.

_____
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD OFFICER DANIEL TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, Brooklyn Robbery Squad;
653 Grand Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11211

NYPD SERGEANT SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, 73rd Precinct; 1470 East New York Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11212

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

ROQUE CONTRERAS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD OFFICER DANIEL
TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, NYPD SERGEANT
SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, and NYPD
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10,

Defendants.

----- X

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC, as
and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On December 12th, 2020, at approximately 8:00 p.m., plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS, while lawfully in the vicinity of Ralph Avenue and St. John's Place in Brooklyn, New York, was subject to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. Plaintiff was then unlawfully imprisoned at the 73rd Precinct Police Station and Kings County Central Bookings for approximately 24 hours before seeing a Judge. Based on the false charges made against him, a Parole hold dropped on Plaintiff, causing him to suffer prolonged confinement as well as the loss of his job, resulting in physical, mental, economic, and emotional injury. Plaintiff was denied the right to due process and a fair trial for false charges, which were dismissed and sealed on or around March 6, 2021, after Plaintiff spent approximately 90 days unlawfully incarcerated. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, confined, subjected to excessive force, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS is a resident of the state of New York.
3. NYPD OFFICER DANIEL TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
4. NYPD OFFICER DANIEL TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 73rd Precinct.
5. NYPD OFFICER DANIEL TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924 is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
6. NYPD SERGEANT SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
7. NYPD SERGEANT SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 73rd Precinct.
8. NYPD SERGEANT SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856 is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
9. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
10. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 were at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 73rd Precinct.
11. NYPD OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.
12. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
13. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible.

The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

14. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

15. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on May 7, 2021.

16. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

17. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

18. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

19. On December 12th, 2020, at approximately 8:00 P.M., Plaintiff was lawfully present in the vicinity of Ralph Avenue and St. John's Place in Brooklyn, New York, when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, and falsely arrested Plaintiff without probable cause or legal justification.

20. Plaintiff was driving his girlfriend's car from New Jersey to a friend's home in Brooklyn, NY.

21. At the intersection of Ralph Avenue and St. John's Place, Plaintiff's right of way was blocked by an unmarked NYPD car that ran the red light.

22. To avoid the unmarked car, and avoid an accident, the plaintiff turned right down another street and let his GPS recalculate the route to his friend's house.

23. The unmarked car followed the plaintiff's vehicle and turned on its blue lights, signaling the plaintiff to pull over; Plaintiff complied immediately.

24. Uniformed police officers exited the unmarked vehicle, approached the plaintiff's window, and asked him for his license and registration documents.

25. Plaintiff's license and registration were both valid.

26. After the plaintiff provided the defendant officers with the requested documents, the officers instructed the plaintiff to step out of his vehicle.

27. Plaintiff asked why he was being asked to exit his vehicle, but the defendant officers refused to answer and told him to comply with their demands.

28. Upon exiting the vehicle, plaintiff was immediately subjected to an unlawful pat-down search, after which defendant officers instructed the plaintiff to stand at the rear of the vehicle while they performed an unlawful search of his car.

29. One of the defendant officers took Plaintiff's keys from his pocket and used them to open the trunk of the car; the officers made the plaintiff sit inside the vehicle while they searched the trunk.

30. Plaintiff did not give Officers permission to search the trunk, nor was there any probable cause to search the trunk.

31. It was at this point that the defendant NYPD officers began to unlawfully arrest the plaintiff, restraining him with metal handcuffs.

32. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

33. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

34. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

35. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

36. The Defendant Officers then placed the Plaintiff in the back of an NYPD vehicle and transported him against his will to the 73rd Precinct, where he was unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed, and placed in a holding cell.

37. After being unlawfully detained at the 73rd precinct, Plaintiff was interrogated by defendant officers and told they'd found a firearm in his trunk; the plaintiff maintained that he'd never seen a gun and did not know about any weapons in his vehicle.

38. The following day, Plaintiff was transported to Kings County Central Bookings, where he was once again unlawfully searched, fingerprinted, photographed, and placed in a holding cell.

39. The defendant police officers provided the Kings County District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

40. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely stated to the Kings County District Attorney's Office that the plaintiff was guilty of criminal possession of a firearm.

41. On December 13, 2020, after approximately 30 hours in unlawful custody, the plaintiff was brought before a Judge and arraigned in criminal court.

42. Plaintiff retained a private criminal defense attorney, Jay Schwitzman, for approximately \$15,000 to fight these false charges.

43. Based on the officers false allegations, a Parole Hold dropped on Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was remanded to Rikers Island Correctional Facility.

44. The Kings County District Attorneys Office then tested the gun for DNA; Plaintiff voluntarily gave his DNA because of his innocence of the false charges.

45. After approximately ninety days, the DNA evidence came back and excluded the Plaintiff as a contributor to the gun.

46. On or around March 6, 2021, after DNA evidence exonerated him completely, the Kings County District Attorney's office dismissed all charges.

47. On March 9, 2021, after approximately ninety days in unlawful custody, the parole hold was lifted and the parole specification was dismissed, and the plaintiff was released from custody at Rikers Island.

48. While serving time at Rikers for crimes he did not commit, the plaintiff sustained a fractured ankle, for which he received no medical treatment; in addition, he lost his job as a UPS delivery driver as a result of this time incarcerated.

49. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, using excessive force, falsely arresting and imprisoning, humiliating, and denying Plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial.

50. The unlawful search, seizure, use of excessive force, false arrest and imprisonment, and denial of Plaintiff's right to a fair trial by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

51. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 50 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

52. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

53. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

54. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 53 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

55. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

56. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

57. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

58. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

59. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

60. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 59 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

61. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning, and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

62. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

63. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

64. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

65. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

66. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 65 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

67. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

68. Defendants lacked probable cause to search Plaintiff.

69. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

70. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

71. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

72. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

73. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 72 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

74. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

75. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

76. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

77. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

78. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

79. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

80. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

81. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights

82. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 81 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

83. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, tightly handcuffing him, and allowing him to remain untreated for a fractured ankle, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

84. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

85. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 84 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

86. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff, ROQUE CONTRERAS. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

87. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

88. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

89. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

90. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

91. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

92. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 91 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

93. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

94. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

95. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 94 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

96. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

97. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

98. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to strip search and other physical constraints.

99. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

100. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

101. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

102. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional, and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

103. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs 1 through 102 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

104. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the State of New York and New York State common law.

105. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against the plaintiff.

106. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for the charges for which they were prosecuted.

107. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

108. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate Plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

109. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

110. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

111. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional, physical, economic, and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

112. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff ROQUE CONTRERAS demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
July 7, 2021

By: 
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorneyw=s for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD OFFICER DANIEL TWOHIG, SHIELD NO. 1924, Brooklyn Robbery Squad;
653 Grand Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11211

NYPD SERGEANT SAMUEL HUI, SHIELD NO. 28856, 73rd Precinct; 1470 East New
York Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11212

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CAITLIN ROBIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
July 7, 2021



CAITLIN ROBIN